through her posthumous book *Reconciliation*, accused him of plotting an attack on her and her supporters in Karachi in October 2007 that killed more than 130 people. Akhtar was subsequently detained, but no formal charges were brought, and he was released after some months (Walsh, 2012). The investigating officer on the case, Nawaz Ranjha, reported to the court that no evidence had been found of the involvement of Qari Saifullah in any terrorist activity and therefore a charge sheet could not be filed against him. He was released on bail but was rearrested under the Maintenance of Public Order (MPO) and taken to a Karachi safe house. However, after five days, on 8 June 2008, Qari Saifullah was released by the Sindh Home Department, stating that the term for his detention had expired (Mir, 2008).

Interestingly, he was also a student of Banuri Mosque in Karachi like Maulana Masood Azhar, the head of Jaish-e-Muhammad (JeM). Qari Saifullah Akhtar was instrumental in the efforts of Mufti Shamzai to establish coordination between Taliban head Mullah Mohammad Omar and Osama bin Laden in their so-called Jihad. He, however, became famous after his involvement in a high-profile conspiracy aimed at overthrowing the government of the then Prime Minister of Pakistan Benazir Bhutto (late) in 1995 by some army officers led by Major General Zaheer ul Islam Abbasi, but all of them were arrested. He managed to secure his release by becoming state-witness. Then, he went to Afghanistan and became an important part of Taliban government. Soon, he became the advisor of Taliban Ameer Mullah Mohammad Omar. Interestingly, although he remained part of Taliban government's administration, he continued to head his own organisation independent of Taliban and had the membership even from the Taliban ranks. However, the majority of fighters for his organisation were from Punjabi Taliban who were paid for their services, which was a unique characteristic of the organisation that made it different from other militant groups.

Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami had a very strong and cohesive organisational structure similar to that of other Jihadi organisations like Lashkar-e-Taiba and Hizbul Mujahideen. However, as mentioned earlier, the presence of the group in certain other countries made the organisation wider and much larger. The group had its offices in Afghanistan, Kabul and Kandahar until the US attack that overthrew the Taliban government. Later on, the group shifted its offices to the tribal areas of Pakistan.